VIRGINIA TECH · CENTER FOR PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION AND POLICY

PAPA PhD Progress Report

Example student

Start: Fall 2025 · Generated October 20, 2026

PROGRESS SUMMARY

33	30	3	6
Total credits of 90	Coursework of 60	Dissertation of 30	DMP sessions of 15

QE READINESS

Constellation IV — Custom: PAPA 6014 — PA theory and context; PAPA 6514 — PA and policy inquiry

QE coursework not ready

Foundation courses: 5/6 completed (5 required). Cornerstone: complete. Policy inquiry: pending. Selected constellation coursework: pending.

Coursework check only. Submit the QE request by May 1 and written materials by August 1; the program confirms exam admission.

QE COURSEWORK CHECKLIST

Complete at least five of the six foundations, both research prerequisites, and every course in your selected constellation. Only recorded completions and approved transfers count.

✓ Completed: **PAPA 6014** — PA theory and context · Constellation

✓ Completed: **PAPA 6114** — Complex public organizations

✓ Completed: **PAPA 6214** — Public policy processes

Pending: **PAPA 6224** — Public policy design

✓ Completed: **PAPA 6344** — Leadership and management in PA

✓ Completed: **PAPA 6414** — Normative foundations of PA

✓ Completed: **PAPA 6294** — Cornerstone seminar

Pending: **PAPA 6514** — PA and policy inquiry · Constellation

QE PAPERS AND PREPARATION

1/2 required papers ready · 1 optional · 0 optional pending

Paper 1: Example: Administrative Theory · PAPA 6014 — PA theory and context · Marked ready

Paper 2: Example: Policy Inquiry · PAPA 6514 — PA and policy inquiry · Pending

Paper 3 (optional): Example: Policy Processes · PAPA 6214 — Public policy processes · Marked ready

Written materials submitted: pending. Oral presentation prepared: yes. See Milestones for the recorded request, packet, essay, oral engagement, and exam result.

SEMESTER PLAN

Transfer in
Elective — Example Graduate Elective A · 3 cr.
Elective — Example Graduate Elective B · 3 cr.

TERM	COURSES	CR.	DONE
Fall 2025 (Sem 1)	PAPA 6014 — PA theory and context PAPA 6114 — Complex public organizations PAPA 6294 — Cornerstone seminar	**9 cr.**	✓
Spring 2026 (Sem 2)	PAPA 6214 — Public policy processes PAPA 6344 — Leadership and management in PA PAPA 6414 — Normative foundations of PA	**9 cr.**	✓
Summer 2026	PAPA 7994 — Dissertation 1	**3 cr.**	
Fall 2026 (Sem 3)	TBD — Example Advanced Qualitative Methods PAPA 5974/AT — Example Organizational Theory Study	**6 cr.**	
Spring 2027 (Sem 4)	PAPA 6224 — Public policy design PAPA 6514 — PA and policy inquiry PAPA 5974/AT — Example Public Management Study	**9 cr.**	
Fall 2027 (Sem 5)	PAPA 5974/AT — Example Policy Implementation Study	**3 cr.**	
Spring 2028 (Sem 6)	PAPA 7964 — Concentration lecture PAPA 6394 — Capstone seminar	**6 cr.**	

COURSE COMPLETION

FOUNDATION COURSES · 15/18 CR.

- [x] PAPA 6014 ~~PA theory and context~~ **3 cr.**
- [x] PAPA 6114 ~~Complex public organizations~~ **3 cr.**
- [x] PAPA 6214 ~~Public policy processes~~ **3 cr.**
- [ ] PAPA 6224 Public policy design **3 cr.**
- [x] PAPA 6344 ~~Leadership and management in PA~~ **3 cr.**
- [x] PAPA 6414 ~~Normative foundations of PA~~ **3 cr.**

RESEARCH FOUNDATIONS & METHODS · 6/9 CR.

- [x] PAPA 6294 ~~Cornerstone seminar~~ **3 cr.**
- [ ] PAPA 6514 PA and policy inquiry **3 cr.**
- [x] TBD ~~Example Advanced Qualitative Methods~~ **3 cr.**

RESEARCH CONCENTRATION · 3/9 CR.

- [x] PAPA 5974/AT ~~Example Organizational Theory Study~~ **3 cr.**
- [ ] PAPA 5974/AT Example Public Management Study **3 cr.**
- [ ] PAPA 5974/AT Example Policy Implementation Study **3 cr.**

CONCENTRATION LECTURE · 0/3 CR.

- [ ] PAPA 7964 Concentration lecture **3 cr.**

CAPSTONE SEMINAR · 0/3 CR.

- [ ] PAPA 6394 Capstone seminar **3 cr.**

DISSERTATION · 3/30 CR.

- [x] PAPA 7994 ~~Dissertation 1~~ **3 cr.**
- [ ] PAPA 7994 Dissertation 2 **3 cr.**
- [ ] PAPA 7994 Dissertation 3 **3 cr.**
- [ ] PAPA 7994 Dissertation 4 **3 cr.**
- [ ] PAPA 7994 Dissertation 5 **3 cr.**
- [ ] PAPA 7994 Dissertation 6 **3 cr.**
- [ ] PAPA 7994 Dissertation 7 **3 cr.**
- [ ] PAPA 7994 Dissertation 8 **3 cr.**
- [ ] PAPA 7994 Dissertation 9 **3 cr.**
- [ ] PAPA 7994 Dissertation 10 **3 cr.**

ELECTIVES · 6/18 CR.

- [x] Elective ~~Example Graduate Elective A~~ **3 cr.**
- [x] Elective ~~Example Graduate Elective B~~ **3 cr.**
- [ ] Elective Elective 3 **3 cr.**
- [ ] Elective Elective 4 **3 cr.**
- [ ] Elective Elective 5 **3 cr.**
- [ ] Elective Elective 6 **3 cr.**

MILESTONES

- [x] ~~**Scholarly ethics quiz**~~
  Year 1 (early)
- [x] ~~**CITI human subjects training**~~
  Year 1
- [x] ~~**Plan of study submitted**~~
  Before 24 credits
- [x] ~~**Constellation selected**~~
  Before QE registration
- [x] ~~**QE request submitted**~~
  By May 1
- [ ] **Submitted papers ready**
  By August 1
- [ ] **Foundations essay completed**
  By August 1
- [ ] **QE oral engagement**
  August, before Fall semester
- [ ] **Qualifying examination passed**
  August result
- [ ] **Dissertation committee formed**
  After qualifying exam
- [ ] **Concentration lecture delivered**
  Before Dec 1 (fall) or May 1 (spring)
- [ ] **Capstone seminar completed**
  Preferably last semester of coursework
- [ ] **Prospectus defense (preliminary exam)**
  After all coursework
- [ ] **Dissertation draft distributed**
  At least 6 weeks before defense
- [ ] **Dissertation defense (final exam)**
  Final requirement

REQUIREMENT REFERENCE

Confirm course eligibility and Plan of Study placement with the appropriate faculty advisor.

Foundation Courses (18 credits)

Six required courses covering five foundational areas of public administration: theory and context, organizations, public policy, management, and ethics. These establish the scholarly foundation for doctoral research.

Research Foundations, Analysis, and Measurement Tools (9 credits)

Three courses developing research design, inquiry, and analytical skills: PAPA 6294 (Cornerstone), PAPA 6514 (Public Administration and Policy Inquiry), and one advisor-approved advanced quantitative or qualitative methods course.

Advanced Methods is one specific three-credit requirement within this nine-credit sequence.

Advanced Methods (3 credits)

One advisor-approved course in advanced quantitative or qualitative research techniques relevant to your research interests. Examples include ethnography, textual analysis, historical research, survey design, time-series analysis, and simulation.

Part of the nine-credit Research Foundations, Analysis, and Measurement Tools sequence, alongside PAPA 6294 and PAPA 6514. Advanced Topics courses do not automatically satisfy the Advanced Methods requirement.

Research Concentration (12 credits total)

An individualized area of specialized study developed with a faculty advisor to build expertise in a subject, theoretical approach, empirical literature, or research methodology.

Nine credits of focused study may include graduate courses, independent studies, internships, or field studies. The work can support dissertation development but does not have to focus on the dissertation topic.

A separate three-credit Concentration Lecture (PAPA 7964) completes the 12-credit requirement. The tracker lists the nine study credits and three lecture credits separately.

Concentration Lecture (PAPA 7964, 3 credits)

A formal presentation integrating your nine credits of research concentration work. Complete it after the focused study and before the dissertation prospectus defense.

Present it to your faculty advisor and an audience of at least six other participants.

Electives (18 credits)

Graduate courses selected to broaden or deepen scholarly expertise. May include PAPA Advanced Topics courses, other Virginia Tech graduate courses, and approved transfer coursework.

Capstone Seminar (3 credits)

PAPA 6394, taken toward the end of coursework, supports the development of an independent research proposal or dissertation prospectus.

Research and Dissertation (30 credits)

PAPA 7994 credits supporting independent doctoral research and dissertation development. Three of the 30 credits are associated with the Doctoral Mentoring Program or approved equivalent activities.